

- **The Reading Pane:** In Outlook 2003, the 'Preview Pane' has been replaced by the 'Reading Pane'. You can read your messages as they would appear on paper in the 'Reading Pane'. The messages list is now vertical instead of horizontal, as in previous versions of Outlook. This provides a large space for the 'Reading Pane' on the right-hand side of the Outlook window. By default, the 'Reading Pane' is initially turned off in the Inbox—you can customise your Outlook 2003 'Reading Pane' to suit your needs. Two icons have been added to the 'Standard Toolbar' to facilitate turning the 'Reading Pane' on or off. You will soon notice that each sub-folder within the Inbox can have its own 'Reading Pane' setting.

Other Reading Pane options can be accessed from the 'Tools' menu by clicking **Tools > Options > Other tab**, and then clicking the 'Reading Pane' button. Options include moving the 'Reading Pane' back to the bottom (as in previous versions of Outlook) and hiding or showing message headers in the 'Reading Pane'.

- **Desktop Alerts:** A Desktop Alert is a notification that appears on your desktop when you receive e-mail items such as an messages, appointments and tasks. You can modify where the alert appears on your desktop, and for what how long it is displayed. By default, it will display in the lower right of your desktop for seven seconds.

In the case of an e-mail message, the alert displays the name of the sender, the subject, and the first two lines of the message. In the case of a meeting request, the alert displays the sender, subject, date, time, and location of the meeting. For a task request, the alert displays the sender, subject, and start date of the assigned task.

- **Address AutoComplete:** This feature suggests names as you type in the To, Cc and Bcc boxes. When you type the first letter of a name in one of these boxes, AutoComplete begins to suggest possible matches based on names you have typed in before. The more letters you type, the more likely is AutoComplete to find a match.